

🔗 C. Lokayukta (Anti-Corruption Ombudsman)

The Uttarakhand Lokayukta derives its authority from the Uttarakhand Lokayukta Act, 2014. Its jurisdiction extends over the Chief Minister, Ministers, and Group A and B public servants. The first Lokayukta was S.H.A. Raja. The office wields Civil Court powers, including the authority to summon witnesses and mandate document production. However, prolonged vacancies and delays in appointments have historically weakened the institution. The current focus is on strengthening its autonomy and streamlining grievance mechanisms.

🔗 D. State Vigilance Agency

Established in 2002, the State Vigilance Agency investigates corruption and abuse of office by state government officials. It operates under the Criminal Procedure Code, 1973, and the Prevention of Corruption Act, with designated police stations in Dehradun and Haldwani. The Anti-Corruption Helpline 1064 allows citizens to report bribery and graft directly via an application. A key challenge identified by the CAG is "Execution-Verification Collusion" — where the same officers who execute works also verify them, enabling fake claims.

🔗 12.6 SPECIALIZED ADMINISTRATIVE BODIES

🔗 A. SETU Aayog (State Institute for Empowering & Transforming Uttarakhand)

SETU Aayog replaced the legacy State Planning Commission and is modelled after NITI Aayog at the national level. Its core philosophy represents a transition from tracking "Outlays" (money spent) to measuring "Outcomes" (actual public utility). The Aayog serves as the nodal agency for Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and prepares the State SDG Index. It fosters cooperative sub-federalism by linking block-level issues to state policy, with a current focus on hill-specific solutions including carrying-capacity assessments and Gross Environment Product (GEP) measurement.

🔗 B. SARA (Spring & River Rejuvenation Authority)

SARA is a newly established authority with the critical mandate to map and revive "dying springs" (Dhara) across the Tehri and Pauri belts. Mountain springs serve as the primary water source for thousands of hill villages, making this work vital to the region's sustainability. The Authority works with local governance structures, combining traditional water management knowledge with modern conservation techniques. Van Panchayats and Panchayati Raj Institutions implement SARA's revival plans on the ground.

🔗 C. UPNL (Uttarakhand Purva Sainik Kalyan Nigam Limited)

Established in 2004, UPNL is the premier agency for rehabilitation of Uttarakhand's veteran population, which includes approximately 1,38,372 ex-servicemen and 48,361 widows (as of March 2023). Its primary service involves outsourced employment in government departments, medical colleges, and corporations. The organization faces several challenges, including the "Equal Pay for Equal Work" crisis, contractual job insecurity, and skill mismatch (radar operators deployed as guards).

Related initiatives include the Him Prahari Yojana (2022), which provides assistance for veterans to settle in border districts, and the Eco-Task Forces established in 2008, which employ ex-servicemen for afforestation and forest fire management. A notable border integration achievement saw 355 farmers (including veterans) supply 1.46 lakh kg of meat and fish to ITBP, generating ₹6.58 crore via Direct Benefit Transfer.

🔗 D. CPPGG (Centre for Public Policy and Good Governance)

The CPPGG functions as the state's internal think-tank for evidence-based policy formulation. Its key activities include conducting baseline surveys on carrying capacity (Nainital, Mussoorie) and managing the State Indicator Framework. It provides technical support to SETU Aayog for monitoring schemes like Lakhpati Didi and helped Uttarakhand achieve a rank of

🔗 14.11 UTTARAKHAND BHU-KANOON (LAND REFORMS AMENDMENT 2025)

🔗 Key Sections

Section 154 controls who can buy land, how much they can buy, and for what purpose. Section 143 controls land-use conversion (agricultural to non-agricultural) and cannot be used to legalize a purchase prohibited under Section 154.

🔗 Major Provisions

Under the amendment, outsiders are prohibited from buying agricultural land in 11 hill districts. Non-residents are limited to a maximum of 250 square metres for residential purposes. Permitted purposes for outside buyers include hotels, resorts, health facilities, educational institutions, tourism projects, and MSMEs — but only through State Government sanction with mandatory background checks.

The rationale is to protect "Jal, Jungle, Jameen" (water, forests, land) and prevent the "Ghost Village to Party Village" transition. The Sub-Divisional Magistrate (SDM) plays a central role in enforcement — verifying affidavits, auditing purposes, and managing registry-mutation integration.

🔗 Three Routes for Land Access

Three routes exist for non-residents seeking land. Route A (Agriculture/Horticulture) is extremely limited for non-residents. Route B (Residential) offers a narrow window with a maximum of 250 sq m. Route C (Project-Based) requires government sanction with rigorous verification.

🔗 14.12 OTHER KEY SCHEMES & POLICIES

Scheme	Category	Details
Pirul Lao-Paise Pao	Ecology	Launched May 8, 2024; pine needle collection for biofuel; turns hazard into revenue
Operation Kalanemi	Security	July 2025; removes fake sadhus from pilgrimage hubs
Vibrant Villages	Border	51 villages designated as "First Villages"; ₹40 crore allocation
Pravasi Panchayat	Migration	Started in Tehri (April 2026); invites successful migrants to showcase self-employment
Mission Apple	Agriculture	High-density Italian apple varieties for hill farmers
Aroma Mission (Mehak Kranti)	Agriculture	Damask Rose, Lavender in "Cinnamon Valley"
PM-JANMAN	Tribal	Saturation coverage for PVTGs (Raji, Buksa)
Mukhyamantri Vatsalya	Child welfare	Support for COVID-19 orphans
Clean Mobility Policy	Transport	Subsidies for clean-fuel commercial vehicles
Geothermal Energy Policy 2025	Energy	Eco-friendly geothermal research and power generation
Foreign Employment Cell	Employment	Based in Sahaspur; helps youth find overseas jobs
Mahatma Jyoti Bapu National Mission	Health	Community health centres in 100 PVTG blocks; 24x7 emergency services